

Michael Calce got his first computer at the age of six. As a 15-year-old, he went on to be known by the online name “Mafiaboy” when he launched a massive cyber-attack. Today, Michael works as a consultant for companies trying to protect their online systems from security breaches.

Kids below the age of seven can easily pick up foreign languages so why can't they learn to code? iPad games such as Kodable teach kids as young as five years old programming fundamentals. If they display a passion for understanding how apps and web sites work, those are early signs that a career in programming could be on the cards at a later stage. Think about your own chosen profession and how it relates to your early life ambitions. If you assemble computers for a living, you probably enjoyed deconstructing and building things as a child.

One may argue that exposure to digital media may be helpful only to those pursuing a career in tech, but the thing is it's all around us, and not going anywhere so we might as well get our kids to jump onto the tech bandwagon, if not for anything else than to prevent goof-ups that could cost them a job.

Balance is important

What would we do without tech? Nothing apparently. When was the last time you dialled a contact number from memory or calculated a discount without the help of a calculator? While calculators are great in a pinch, you don't want to be suckered into using any device that threatens to leave you mentally dependent on it. So let's not deprive the little one the knowledge of the basic ways of surviving just in case technology fails us when we need it the most. 